

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-07-15

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 118:8-29

8 It is better to trust in the Lord Than to put confidence in man.

9 It is better to trust in the Lord Than to put confidence in princes.

10 All nations surrounded me, But in the name of the Lord I will destroy them.

11 They surrounded me, Yes, they surrounded me; But in the name of the Lord I will destroy them.

12 They surrounded me like bees; They were quenched like a fire of thorns; For in the name of the Lord I will destroy them.

13 You pushed me violently, that I might fall, But the Lord helped me.

14 The Lord is my strength and song, And He has become my salvation.

15 The voice of rejoicing and salvation Is in the tents of the righteous; The right hand of the Lord does valiantly.

16 The right hand of the Lord is exalted; The right hand of the Lord does valiantly.

17 I shall not die, but live, And declare the works of the Lord.

18 The Lord has chastened me severely, But He has not given me over to death.

19 Open to me the gates of righteousness; I will go through them, And I will praise the Lord.

20 This is the gate of the Lord, Through which the righteous shall enter.

21 I will praise You, For You have answered me, And have become my salvation.

22 The stone which the builders rejected Has become the chief cornerstone.

23 This was the Lord's doing; It is marvelous in our eyes.

24 This is the day the Lord has made; We will rejoice and be glad in it.

25 Save now, I pray, O Lord; O Lord, I pray, send now prosperity.

26 Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord! We have blessed you from the house of the Lord.

27 God is the Lord, And He has given us light; Bind the sacrifice with cords to the horns of the altar.

28 You are my God, and I will praise You; You are my God, I will exalt You.

29 Oh, give thanks to the Lord, for He is good! For His mercy endures forever.

II. Key Summary

- The psalmist says trusting the Lord is better than relying on people or princes; even when all nations surround him and he is pushed down, he wins and is helped in the name of the Lord (vv. 8-13).
 - The psalmist declares that the Lord is his strength, song, and salvation, and says he will not die but live to tell what the Lord has done (vv. 14-19).
 - The psalmist points out that the stone the builders rejected became the chief cornerstone—this is the Lord's doing and His day—then he cries out for salvation and gives thanks that God is good and His mercy endures forever (vv. 22-29).
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III. Passage Analysis

Topic 1: Trusting God Is Steadier Than Trusting People

"Man is weak, but God is Almighty; man is often faithless and deceitful, but God never is. Leaning on people is like trusting a broken staff or a mere shadow—it cannot hold you up." [1]

Relying on friends or family isn't wrong, but people get tired, change, and sometimes can't carry you. The point here is that putting the final weight on God is the one place that actually holds.

Topic 2: The Stone That Was Thrown Away Became the Most Important One

"The stone the builders rejected became the most valuable stone in the edifice—the

one on which the whole superstructure rests." [2]

A cornerstone is the single stone the entire building leans on. Being overlooked or left out doesn't mean you're worthless in God's eyes—He often takes the very stone everyone tossed aside and uses it to hold everything up.

IV. Reflection Question

When something goes wrong and you can't fix it yourself, who's the first person you turn to—a friend, your parents, or just gritting your teeth alone? This psalm says it is better to trust in the Lord than to put confidence in man—so what would change if God were on that list, and at the top of it?

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Barnes' Notes / Gill's Exposition,
<https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/psalms/118-8.htm>

[2] BibleHub.com, Barnes' Notes / Treasury of David,
<https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/psalms/118-22.htm>